

The... SECRETS of Your HIGHER MIND

By John Hinds

When Edgar Cayce was asked for insight into the workings of the higher mind and psychic abilities, he often recommended that people study *The Law of Psychic Phenomena*. This book was written over 100 years ago by Dr. Thomson Jay Hudson. Hudson's insights can help you understand the power and creativity of your higher self. Hudson explains the laws and conditions under which the powers of your higher mind, its creativity, its intuition, and its psychic abilities, can be experienced to their fullest extent.

Most psychologists, even parapsychologists, have been unaware of Hudson's work. Hudson's books were popular around the turn of the century and then faded into relative obscurity. Cayce, however, recommended *The Law of Psychic Phenomena* more than once as a good way to understand the often bewildering world of psychic phenomena and hypnosis. As a matter of fact, the implications of Hudson's work go far beyond that. Hudson provides a way for you to understand the power of faith in your life on a psychological basis.

I recently reviewed some of the psychological and parapsychological research findings relevant to Hudson's work. Not only does Hudson stand up amazingly well; he is able to answer questions that are still puzzling researchers. What is *The Law of Psychic Phenomena* about and how can you apply some of Hudson's insights in your own life?

Your Subjective Mind

Hudson presents a model of how your subconscious mind – what he called the “subjective mind” – works. Essentially, this is the same higher mind that Cayce referred to as the “soul-mind.” How does your subjective mind work and how

can you tap its vast abilities?

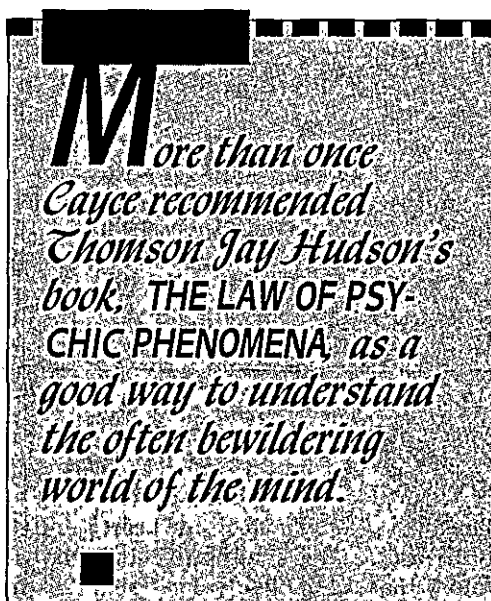
Hudson believed that your subjective mind is the source of your intuitive and creative abilities. It is the state of consciousness that comes to the fore when you are put into the hypnotic state. Your subjective mind (according

to Hudson) is inherently psychic. Potentially, everybody has psychic abilities. The subjective mind puts things together; it synthesizes and intuitively rather than analyzes.

The subjective mind is the part of your consciousness that survives death and becomes your normal consciousness in the afterlife. It is independent of your body and your senses, and in the afterlife state has access to higher truth. In that condition you have no need to form opinions and hypotheses about the nature of the

universe. Whatever you need to know or understand will come into your mind.

Your subjective mind is not capable of forming propositions about the nature of things because it has no innate need to do so. That is the job of your objective, conscious mind. Your ordinary consciousness (what Hudson



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called the "objective mind") analyzes and separates. It is your three-dimensional mind which copes with the everyday, material world. Your objective mind forms opinions and has beliefs. These opinions may or may not be "true."

While you are in a body your subjective mind depends on your objective mind's knowledge, intelligence, and beliefs to guide it. It has no earthly knowledge of its own (with three exceptions which I'll explain later) and gets all its knowledge from the objective mind. Although your subjective mind is in many ways more creative and powerful than your conscious mind, while you are in a body, your subjective mind becomes the servant of your objective mind and accepts its limitations. Your subjective mind takes any suggestion given to it as the truth and works out all of the implications and ramifications of the suggestion to the nth degree.

This is exactly what would happen to you if you were hypnotized deeply enough. If a hypnotist told you that you were a chicken or that Winston Churchill was coming to tea, once your subjective mind had accepted the suggestion as fact, it would then work out all the details and provide a perfectly plausible rationale why it is so. You would perceive and act as if this were your reality as long as the suggestion was accepted.

The Subjective Mind and Hypnosis

Hudson's great insight was to realize that the hypnotic state is not exotic or unusual but is simply the subjective mind coming to the fore with the objective mind in temporary abeyance. Hudson went far beyond most philosophies of mental science to construct a theory that made sense out of a wide range of different and puzzling phenomena including hypnosis, psychic abilities, creativity and the power of faith or expectancy. That is probably what commended his work to Cayce and what makes him so relevant today. One of the primary missions of the A.R.E. is research into the higher states of consciousness and abilities of people. Cayce recommended Hudson as a good place to begin understanding and investigating these things.

Hudson states that your subjective mind will always take the suggestions of the objective mind as the truth and

proceed to work them out. But whose objective mind? Your subjective mind will accept whatever suggestion is strongest and that suggestion can just as easily come from the objective mind of another person as from your own objective mind. That is what happens to you when you are hypnotized: Your objective mind is relaxed and is open. Your subjective mind is then able to take suggestions from the objective mind of the hypnotist without interference from your objective mind. Autosuggestion or self-hypnosis is simply the same process with the suggestions coming from your own objective mind rather than another's. The reason some people cannot be hypnotized is that strong counter-suggestions from their objective minds block the suggestions of the hypnotist.

Harmonizing the Objective and Subjective Minds

Your objective mind feeds your subjective mind opinions as facts all the time. Your beliefs (conscious or not) are continually conditioning your subjective mind. Your subjective mind takes these suggestions and creates your experience of reality according to how and what you believe. It helps create your own personal reality in order for you to experience your inner thoughts and feelings, your subjective being, "in the flesh." According to Cayce, this is the primary reason for experience in the material world. This is also your challenge and opportunity for growth – to get your objective mind working in harmony with your subjective or soul mind.

Cayce says the way to get better and clearer messages from your higher self is to listen to the still, small voice within you and start acting on its messages. To do this safely, you need inner balance and a guiding ideal. Your ideals are your guideposts, they help cre-

ate your highest possibilities as well as responsibilities.

The subjective mind needs a good, well-ordered conscious mind to keep it in balance. The subjective mind without this balance is like a ship without a compass or a rudder. Your two types of mind are meant to work together. You need the intelligence and abilities of your objective mind. It has a purpose, too. The discrimination of your objective mind is needed to determine when your inner voice is truly in accord with your own highest ideals and when it is something less than that. If the subjective mind has full sway, fixations, compulsions or insanity could result. (Hugh Lynn Cayce warned about some dangerous ways of looking within, in his book *Venture Inward*.) Similarities between pathology and genius have often been noted. Some types of pathology probably are the result of too much of the subjective mind without the balancing force of the objective.

On the other



This antique photo, circa 1898, shows Thomson Jay Hudson in his study with his grandchildren

hand, when the objective and subjective minds are in perfect communication and balance, the result is a genius in some field of expression, whether in the arts or the sciences.

The Seat of Perfect Memory

Based on the ability of people under hypnosis to recall events in great detail, Hudson believed that the subjective mind has a perfect memory of everything that happens to you.

This is difficult to prove, since the subjective mind is so amenable to suggestion. There is a controversy raging

The subjective mind seems adept at creating plausible psychological fictions in order to fill in gaps in information it is asked about, or even just to meet its listeners' expectations.

now in psychology and in law over the recovery of repressed memories. Are they memories of actual events or are they "planted" there by unwitting therapists? Unless there is other, corroborating evidence, there is no way to decide this question. Even though Hudson considered the subjective mind to have perfect memory, it is also possible that it could fabricate memories according to expectations or suggestions from an objective mind. In fact, Hudson suggested that the reason some psychics seem to lie (outside of cases of obvious fraud) was that the subjective mind desires to please its hearers. If psychic abilities failed, a person's subjective mind might supply a plausible fiction to fill in the gaps of the accepted premises.

Unless the subjective mind is entirely free from influences from an objective mind (a thing impossible in this life) there does not seem to be any way to discriminate reliably between a "planted" memory and a real one. If a person's trauma is relieved as repressed memories come out, or if dreams about certain incidents recur,

such "memories" are important as psychological truths or events. Although they may or may not be literally true, they are psychologically true regardless. The fact that you felt abused as a child is an important fact for you in the present (psychologically) whether or not it literally happened in the past. Your feelings of being abused are still active and affecting your present experience. You may never be able to find out the literal truth but you can work at healing the part of you that holds those hurt feelings. However, knowledge of how the subjective mind works can help explain the ease by which very convincing memories may be unwittingly planted because of a therapist's own expectations.

The Inherent Knowledge of the Subjective Mind

Based on observation, Hudson found three areas in which the subjective mind has inherent abilities: music, mathematics, and temporal perception. The knowledge or patterns of these three areas are universal, and form an inherent part of the subjective mind. Interestingly, it is in just these areas where some unusual phenomena occur. Some children display amazing abilities in these areas without much formal training. Perhaps these prodigies have access to knowledge from their subjective minds that is not accessible to the rest of us.

Then there is the phenomenon of the *idiot savant*. An idiot savant is a person (usually with low intelligence and/or education) who is able to display powers in memory, math, or music that are the stuff of genius. Science has no explanation for their abilities. Musical savants may reproduce musical compositions exactly after a single hearing. Math savants can perform astonishing calculations almost instantly. In some cases savants can tell you certain prime numbers which cannot be calculated by any known means. Others display amazing feats of memory or time (such as telling you what day of the week February 14, 2786 will be). Dustin Hoffman's character in the movie *Rain Man* is an example. Often, as savants receive more education, their abilities fade. Hudson explained the abilities of savants as the predominance of their subjective minds. Even

though they may have a limited objective knowledge or intelligence, their usual abilities come from the inherent knowledge and abilities of their subjective minds.

Modern Research

Do Hudson's ideas stand up in the light of modern scientific knowledge? I know of no research that contradicts Hudson's model. On the other hand, there is much that appears to confirm it. Research in parapsychology has shown that when you are in a hypnotic state you are more likely to successfully demonstrate psychic abilities (called "psi" by researchers). In fact, hypnosis is one of the best and most consistent facilitators of psi. This is exactly what you would expect if the subjective mind is psychic and operates in the hypnotic state.

If Hudson is right, you might expect that people who believe they can show ESP on a test would tend to score significantly above chance, indicating that something other than "guessing" is taking place. There has been a modest but significant finding in psi research that supports this. More surprising, but consistent with Hudson's model, is the fact that people who don't believe they can demonstrate any ESP on a test tend to score significantly below chance. It seems as if the subjective minds of such people are deliberately "failing" by using their psychic abilities to prove that they don't have any! If they really had no psychic abilities, their results would be near chance, no better than guessing.

Hudson's model has far wider and down-to-earth applications in psychology than psi. Two consistent "confounds" in psychological research are the expectations of researchers and subjects biasing the results. Hudson's ideas may help explain in part how these expectations influence outcomes.

Your Beliefs and Your Health

The mind/body connection is well known. What is less well known is how your mental states affect your health. It is not clear why stress brings about illness in some people but not in others, or how stress works to produce a variety of symptoms at a much later point in time. Perhaps your subjective mind plays a role here.

According to Hudson, the subjective
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tive mind can bring about direct physical changes. Therefore, your beliefs about yourself and your health can be directly translated into your body. The fact that beliefs affect health has long been taken for granted in science, where it is often called the "expectancy effect" or the "placebo effect." Medical science has had no clear idea of just how a person's beliefs affect his health. Instead of using belief as a means of helping to bring about healing, it has simply regarded the placebo effect as an "artifact," a factor that can invalidate the results of a scientific experiment unless it is taken into account.

Who knows what kinds of results medicine may achieve when it learns how to work with the power of faith and the subjective mind to increase the effectiveness of treatment?

In Conclusion

Your subjective mind appears to work according to your faith or beliefs. We all appear to have this creative level of consciousness operating within us. Perhaps, as Cayce and others have suggested, there is a series of such "higher selves" within us. Your subjective mind may describe only the first (or final) link in this chain, but Hudson's description of how your subjective mind operates provides invaluable insights for beginning the journey across this next frontier. It seems that what you believe may become your reality in more profound ways than science has imagined. It may literally be a case of "believing is seeing." You can open yourself to discovering the secrets and the powers of the subjective mind by letting go of limiting beliefs. Does it make sense for you to impose limitations on yourself if your higher mind is going to accept and act on them? Understanding the role faith and belief play in creating our reality confirms the axiom of the Ageless Wisdom that "energy follows thoughts" and that, as Cayce said so often, "Mind is the Builder." Now that you understand a little better how faith actually works and the effect of your beliefs from a psychological perspective, you can begin to examine your faith and beliefs with new awareness and understanding. Does it make any sense for you to settle for anything less than the highest and the best? Cayce didn't think so!

THE CAYCE READINGS CD-ROM FORUM

If you are stuck trying to research the Cayce readings on your computer, here is the place to send your questions and get some help—the Cayce Readings CD-ROM Forum. Or, if you've discovered a helpful shortcut or search approach, send it to us.

Q. Is there a way to go directly from the Index to the referenced paragraph in the Text, Background, or Reports? For example, in searching the Indexes for a particular word, I find what I'm looking for, but then I want to go directly to the referenced document.

A. Unfortunately, there is no automatic way to do this, but there are methods to facilitate moving from an Index to other parts of the reading. The approach is different depending on whether you are using the DOS version or the Windows/Mac version.

Windows & Mac users: In order to move between different parts of a reading, you need to have the Directory List/Folder List selected for "All" before starting a search. With "All" selected, the documents isolated from a search are queued up for browsing in the order of Index, Text, Background, and Reports.

Consider an example of how this strategy might work. Search on the phrase "second coming," and you'll get 49 occurrences in 41 documents, queued up with the indexes first. As you move from index to index, using the "go to next document" button on the tool bar, suppose that 262-103 catches your attention because the index shows that this reading also concerns Christmas, and you're intrigued by the connection. However, it just so happens that the Text of reading 262-103 never uses the exact words "second coming" and so that document hasn't been selected and isn't part of the documents queued up right now. However, so as to not destroy the queued-up set of documents you're going to want to go back to, you can get to the Text in the following way. Click on the "Suspend" button on the tool bar. This shifts you to "Level 2," as you'll see noted at the top of the screen. In the "Search Phrase #1" box, type in "text of reading 262-103" and then hit "Enter." The text of the reading will be found and you can look through it. When you're done, click on "Resume" from the tool bar and you're back to

Level 1, ready to continue your investigation of documents still queued up from your original search.

DOS users: Using the Advance Search screen, let's execute a different example search. Type in for S1 the single word "measles" and execute a search with F7. Your search will isolate 136 documents. The DOS version queues up isolated documents grouped by Case and Sequence number. The grouping is in this order: Reports, Background, Text, and Index. By default, the documents are displayed in descending Case number order.

To move to a Text document from an Index, all that you need to do is press the browse key for backing up, i.e. the key pad minus (-) key and you will move directly to the corresponding Text document. After reviewing the Text press F4 to return to the Document Header Screen. At the Header Screen you can rapidly browse using the key pad plus (+) key to locate the next Index or any other listed document.

One problem may occur, although not frequently with searches of medical topics. As we saw in the example of searching on the phrase "Second Coming," an Index may be isolated but not the corresponding Text because the exact words don't appear in the Text. When this situation arises with the DOS version, it's best to make note of the actual document number of the Index and return to the Advanced Search screen to initiate a new search. The Text will be the document with a number exactly one higher (the Background two higher; the Report, three higher). For example, suppose you took a close look at this measles entry from the Document Summary Screen:

38353 2577-001 INDEX M 51

The Text of reading 2577-001 (i.e., document number 38354, which is one higher than the document number for the Index) doesn't contain the word measles. You would need to return to the Advanced Search Screen and enter this search statement: S2 doc 38354

This will allow you to proceed into the Text itself. You'll then have to return to the Advanced Search screen and re-run your original S1 search statement to re-create the list of isolated documents to continue your investigation.